Tool safety and hygiene card

White standard edition

Using gardening tools safely.

Before use

The adult checks each tool, task and working space. Wear suitable footwear, cover cuts and use suitable gloves. Gloves do not protect against every sharp edge. Stop and tell the adult about damage.

Carry and pass

Walk with tools low and sharp ends pointing down and away from people. Keep a clear gap. Park the tool before changing jobs. Secateurs stay closed and locked for pupil carrying; place them down for the next person rather than passing open blades.

Use and clean

Use the correct tool over the tray or approved work area. Keep your free hand clear. The adult controls sharp blades, cutting permission and blade cleaning. Brush soil off blunt tools with a separate brush, wipe and dry them under supervision.

Store and wash

Put tools in their designated dry storage, sharp parts protected. Keep the walking route clear. No tasting, sniffing or blowing material. Wash hands with soap and water even after gloves. Park tools and tell an adult before a quiet pause.